

- i. My name is Alaihela Yammanalage Amali Aanya Piyari Wipulasena. I was born on 20/June/1990 in Ratnapura.
- ii. My father's name is A. Y. Wipulasena. And he resides at of 363, Araliya Uyana, Malwala Road, Ratnapura. He is 65 years old.
- iii. My mother's name is P. C. Malkanthi. A resident also of 363, Araliya Uyana, Malwala Road, Ratnapura. She is 58 years old. My mother is currently in a vegetative state and receives palliative care at home.
- iv. I have trained as a psychologist with my basic degree in psychology and thereafter I have trained as a journalist starting my journalism career at the Sunday Times in 2011. I was awarded the best young journalist of the year in 2014. Subsequently, I was awarded a scholarship to study journalism at the prestigious school of journalism in Manorama School of Communication in Kerala.
- v. Following the Covid-19 outbreak, I left full time journalism for Sri Lankan media, after being the associate features editor at the Sunday Observer.
- vi. I have since then being the Sri Lankan Correspondent for Agencia EFE, a Spanish News Agency based out of Madrid. I have also reported for international news organizations such as the BBC, The Guardian, The New York Times, The Australian Broadcasting Corporation, Bloomberg and the Globe and Mail.
- vii. I am also a Chevening fellow, awarded to mid-career journalists from South Asia and was trained at the University of Westminster in the UK. I am also a Reporters Without Borders fellow and was trained in Berlin.

- viii. I have a profile on several online platforms, where international journalists could contact local journalists for freelance assignments, such as LinkedIn.Com.
- ix. On Sunday the **18 May 2025**, I noticed that I have received an email from one of the platforms that I have registered on, PayDesk.com, indicating that I have received a message about an assignment. On checking the PayDesk platform I saw a message from **Eirian Jane Prosser** who claimed she is a journalist Daily Mail, a newspaper in the UK.
- x. The message said she was urgently looking for a reliable journalist in Colombo who can help with a story for the Daily Mail. She asked if I would be available for this work.
- xi. I searched about her on Google and LinkedIn and established that she is a journalist from Daily Mail and contacted her first by adding her on LinkedIn and then by messaging her on Pay Desk saying that I was available and asked her about the assignment.
- xii. Subsequently she added me on LinkedIn and contacted me and indicated the story was about **Charlotte May Lee**, a young British woman arrested at Colombo airport with 46Kg of Kush in her luggage.
- xiii. **Eirian** said she was on her way from the UK to Colombo to cover this story for Daily Mail. She indicated she was contacting me at a stopover enroute from London to Colombo and will be in Colombo that evening (18 May) and requested me to do some of the preliminary research that was necessary for the story.

- xiv. She confirmed that she will pay me a daily fee for which I agreed as per the usual fees that are the industry standard in Sri Lanka for such assignments.
- xv. Following the agreement on the fee, I did the initial research and contacted the acting Customs Spokesperson **Sudattha Silva** around 10.30am. After confirming the detection, **Mr. Silva** said that the suspect was handed over to the Police Narcotics Bureau.
- xvi. Thereafter, I contacted the Police Narcotics Bureau **Director SSP Prashantha** who indicated the said suspect was in the Police Narcotics Bureau custody and said she will be produced in courts on Monday, and I could meet him the next morning or evening.
- xvii. I told to **Eirian** about this and agreed to meet her Monday (19) early morning and she agreed to accompany me to the Police Narcotics Bureau. At this point **Eirian** informed me that a photographer is already in Colombo and that he will also be accompanying us the next morning.
- xviii. On Monday morning (19) I booked a vehicle from Kangaroo Cabs, for the whole day, and went to the Taj Samudra Hotel in Colombo as indicated by **Eirian** as the location she will be staying. I met **Eirian** at Taj Samudra at around 8.00am. **Eirian** introduced me to a man who she said was a photographer. He introduced himself to me as Tim. I did not do a subsequent check on this man as he was introduced through a party- **Eirian**- whose credentials I have already established.
- xix. At this point I inquired whether they had their media accreditation from Sri Lanka, and I was informed that they had not. As I had been informed also by a court reporter whom I knew that the case would be taken

up by at least 9.30am at Negombo. I did not have time to pursue the media accreditation, and I informed them that they cannot work in Sri Lanka without the media accreditation and as such I would do the reporting and for them to be observers. They agreed to this.

- xx. However, the man- **Tim**- was unhappy about this and indicated such restrictions would not be placed on journalists and likened Sri Lanka to African countries. I told him that it was the same laws in the UK where I had studied.
- xxi. Because of the information from the court reporter, we went straight to the Negombo Court without meeting the Police Narcotics Bureau Director.
- xxii. At the court, a security guard allowed us to go in. However, I was in the area allowed to journalists while **Eirian and Tim** stayed in the public space. As there was no indication of the case concerning the suspect was being called, I inquired from several lawyers who indicated the case will be taken in the afternoon. Around lunch I again inquired from a court officer who said the case had already been taken up on the previous day. I then inquired from another lawyer, **Ranjan Jayasinghe**, who provided me with the information that the suspect was remanded at the Negombo Prison.
- xxiii. I informed this to **Eirian** who suggested we immediately go to the prison and inquire whether we can meet the suspect.
- xxiv. I called the **Prison Spokesperson Gamini B. Dissanayake** several times at this point. (14:23, 14:23, 14:25, 14:27) however there was no answer. I also messaged him asking if I could call him. There was no response.

- xxv. Subsequently, we went to the prison which was about 5 minutes away from the courthouse. At the Negombo Prison I introduced myself as a journalist, produced my media card and inquired from the guards who were manning the guardhouse outside the prison whether I could speak to the suspect. And a prison officer (male) said that I can. However, a female officer who was there said it is better to check from 'inside' and the male officer took my media card went inside returned a few minutes later and said there was no issue, and I could go in to see the suspect if she is willing. To my recollection, the same officer indicated that the two foreigners who were with me can also go in.
- xxvi. The officer took my national identity card and requested for identity documents from the two foreigners. As they did not have anything in their hand. The foreign nationals asked if their driver's license would be sufficient and the prison officers said it was.
- xxvii. When the two foreign nations went back to the car to retrieve the driver's licence, I spoke to the male prison officer (inside the guard house in the presence of other three or four officers) and said **Eirian and Tim** may write to the paper about **Charlotte's** case. They could record the interview. I told him that I was waiting for an opportunity, while **Eirian and Tim** was not around to tell them this. The officer said anyone can write about it. And pointing at a man standing near the guard home he said, "he can also write the story." When I said about the recording/ photography the officers said that it will not be allowed inside and there are prison officers inside who will make sure anything of the sort will not

happen. I said this as I was unsure about Tim, due to his negative attitude about the laws of Sri Lanka.

- xxviii. I told a female officer to inform the officers inside the prison to also please be vigilant. She said they will be vigilant anyway.
- xxix. When **Eirian and Tim** returned with their driver's license. The female officer noted their information down. She mentioned me as 'Mithuriya' and I said I was not a friend of Charlotte's. That I was a journalist. She said that 'Mithuriya' is what they normally mention in the record. Another female officer also said that this was normally done.
- xxx. I told this female officer in Sinhala to tell **Eirian and Tim** that photography/recordings are strictly not allowed inside. She said it and I translated it to both **Eirian and Tim**. They said that they will not. Their names were also mentioned as friends by the officer who wrote down the details despite me indicating that they are also journalists.
- xxxi. Our chit with names were taken inside to check with **Charlotte** whether she would want to speak to us. I repeated to **Eirian and Tim** that they should not do anything that is illegal and put me at risk. They said they will not.
- xxxii. Inside the prison we had to stay outside the women's wing for some time till we were allowed inside. When our turn came a female officer asked us to switch our phones off. She looked at my phone and I asked her to check **Eirian and Tim's** too. The officer did.
- xxxiii. We met **Charlotte**. She was in a white top and was happy to see us. She told us about her life in prison.
- xxxiv. During this time, I saw **Tim** standing in an odd posture. He had an object that looked like a large pen

(black, big) near his waist, coming out of his waistline, and he was standing in a strange posture with the object facing **Charlotte**.

- xxxv. At this point, I was more suspicious of **Tim**'s behaviour. However, it was only a suspicion.
- xxxvi. **Eirian** asked **Charlotte** if she wanted anything and she could bring them to her the next day. **Charlotte** asked for clothes. I asked the female officer if it was okay to bring these clothes the next day. She said yes.
- xxxvii. We returned to Colombo. We discussed the story, and I formulated the basis of the report I was going to write.
- xxxviii. Eirian said she would buy the clothes.
- xxxix. As we did not have any meals during the whole day, I was very tired and opted to go straight home.
- xl. At home I told Dr. Aruna Kulatunga, a close friend, and a former journalist, that I was suspicious that **Eirian and Tim** were recording the interview. I called **Tharindu** (a senior journalist) for advice that night. But he did not pick up. I messaged him saying I need advice on a matter. He did not reply but had called me after I went to sleep and I missed that call because the phone was on silent.
- xli. Early in the morning on 20th May, (next morning) when discussing the matter further with Dr. Aruna Kulatunga he said the device could be a spy camera.
- xl.ii. At this point I was advised by Dr. Kulatunga to speak to **SSP Shani Abeysekara** who I had some contact previously, as my attempts to get through to the prison's spokesperson was futile the previous day.
- xl.iii. Therefore, I sent a message to **SSP Shani** Abeysekera indicating I would like to speak to him and get his advice. I also sent a message to **Ravi**

Seneviratne, Public Security Ministry Secretary, also indicating if I could speak to him (5.45am).

- xliv. At 6.14am **SSP Shani** called back. I told him that there were two UK journalists I am working with on the **Charlotte** case, but I have a suspicion that they could be recording the interview with a hidden device. I told him I asked prison officers to be vigilant about the two journalists. I also told him we were going there that morning again.
- xliv. **SSP Shani** called back asking me to send all details to him (our names and time we will be going to the prison) and that he will take appropriate action. At 6.33am I messaged this information.
- xlvi. **Mr. Ravi** messaged me back at 6.55am saying I could call him. I messaged him saying this was about a security breach at Negombo Prison and that I already informed **SSP Shani** and he was looking into it. I called **Mr. Ravi** and told him what happened. He said to inform the Prison's Department, and I said I tried several times. He asked to call again, and he will inform too if he meets the Prison Commissioner.
- xlvi. I called the **Prison Spokesman** at 7.19am. There was no answer.
- xlvi. Due to the assurance given by **SSP Shani** that he will act and advice from Dr. Kulatunga to go along and observe any further developments; I did not pursue this matter after again trying to call the prison spokesman at 7.19am.
- xlix. Prison Spokesman had called back after, but I missed that call because I was on my way to meet **Eirian and Tim**.
- 1. We went to the prison around 10am. It was easier than the day before to get in. A female officer wrote down our information in a book. She mentioned me

as ‘Mithuriya’ again and I informed that I was a journalist and not a friend. She said this this was what they do normally. She did the same with **Eirian and Tim’s** information.

- li. We entered the prison premises. The male officer who I had spoken to the previous day greeted us.
- lii. At the female wing a female officer checked our phones to see if they were switched off and let us in. **Eirian and Tim** went in the room. I stayed near the desk of the female officers. A female officer asked if we were lawyers and I said no and that we were journalists.
- liii. **Eirian** gave the clothes, she had purchased the previous day from the Cool Planet at Galle Face Mall, to **Charlotte**.
- liv. While talking to **Charlotte** I saw **Tim** lifting his shirt once. I saw the object like the pen again.
- lv. I told the female officer to look at **Eirian and Tim**. I tried to mention this secretly because if they were not recording, I would be making an issue unnecessarily. The female officer looked but did not see any problem. I again indicated to check. She then said the time was up. But **Eirian and Tim** did not hear. And I told the female officers to talk louder and make them stop.
- lvi. After the meeting we got back to Colombo. I was very disappointed as I expected some action would have been taken further to my discussion in the morning with SSP Shani. I tried my best to inform the prison officers and other officials, and they did nothing. I felt let down.
- lvii. I messaged Dr. Kulatunga of my disappointment.
- lviii. After coming out of the prison, I contacted the sister of Charlotte, through an online platform as I wanted

to contact Charlotte's lawyers and discuss my suspicions. When I previously asked Charlotte for her lawyer's information, she could not remember the name. The sister, Sofie, refused to give me the Lawyer's name and indicated that she did not want her sister to talk to any journalists. This conversation clearly indicates that I had said I was a journalist from the outset.

- lix. Later in the evening, around 18:17 I also contacted Mr. Gayan, who I was informed, is a lawyer working on the case on behalf of Charlotte. I explicitly informed Mr. Gayan that I am a journalist and that I was covering the case of Charlotte. Mr. Gayan said he is the junior lawyer in the case and to talk to his senior lawyer, Sampath Perera. However, I did not contact Mr. Perera as by this time, I had decided not to follow up on the matter due to the disappointment that no action was being taken by those in authority.
- lx. I then spoke to a senior journalist in the UK (**Gavin**) whom I had worked on a previous story from Bloomberg and asked him for advice. He said to inform the Daily Mail editor in an email. He said since **Daily Mail** has lawyers they will not allow something like this to be published. Gavin gave me the email address to a senior editor.
- lxi. After receiving the email address from Gavin, I sent an email to the editor concerned (9:17 PM) expressing my disappointment over the ethical issues and requesting strongly not to use any content that may have been obtained through illegal or unethical means as that can jeopardize my career and reputation in Sri Lanka. I also informed him that I will not be working on this story anymore and that I

will sever all relationship with Eirian. I also sent the invoice as I was not going to contact Eirian again.

- lxii. He replied few minutes later indicating that he will process the invoice. However, as my primary concern was not the invoice but the possible illegal and unethical behaviour of his team I replied at 10.04 pm restressing that any content obtained inside the prison or courthouse should not be used in any manner or form. There was no reply to this email.
- lxiii. However, the next morning, **21/05/25**, I received a message from Eirian indicating that she will be returning to UK and asking me to provide the invoice for payment.
- lxiv. I wrote a note to her on **Pay Desk**, where she initially contacted me, and said I am telling her again not to publish any illegally/unethically obtained material. I messaged her and asked her to check Pay Desk. She replied saying she has informed her editors about this.
- lxv. I later found that **Daily Mail** has published them regardless.